

St. Thomas Public Safety

St. Thomas Public Safety
Summer 2025

Patrol Sergeant – Libby Barnhart

Community Liaison and DEI Specialist - Reginald Wright



Where are we located?



Public Safety is located on both St. Paul and Minneapolis campuses.



In St. Paul: Our office is in Morrison Hall right next to LOT B and the baseball field.



In Minneapolis: We have Officers assigned to several desks, including Minneapolis School of Law, Terrence Murphy Hall, The Skybox and Minneapolis Opus Hall. Minneapolis Campus hours: 6:00 AM- 12:00 AM



Dispatch Center: Our department operates with the use of a Dispatch center. All calls to our department will be routed through dispatch, then sent to specific Officers in either St. Paul or Minneapolis campus.



We are keeping campus safe 24-hours a day/7 days per week/365 days per year.

How to get ahold of us?

- All calls on-campus should be directed through our dispatch center.
- **Public Safety Non-Emergency Line: 651-962-5100**
- **From an on-campus phone dial 2-5100**
- Use the Non-Emergency Line for the following reasons:
 - You need access to your dorm, office, or other areas
 - Your vehicle won't start, and you need a jump start or you locked your keys in your car.
 - You would like a vehicle or walking escort
 - You have a question for Public Safety
- **Public Safety Emergency Line: 651-962-5555**
- **From an on-campus phone dial 2-5555**
- Use the Emergency Line for the following reasons:
 - You witnessed a crime
 - You are a victim of a crime
 - You are reporting suspicious activity
 - Someone needs emergency help
- If you think it is an emergency, call the emergency line.
- **Or Use our New Safe Zone App!**



Safe Zone Safety App



Public Safety is happy to announce that we are rolling out a new app that will enhance our service to the community.



Here is a short introductory video:
<https://vimeo.com/502347060>

The background image shows a university campus during autumn. On the left, a large tree with vibrant red and orange leaves stands in front of a black lamppost. A white banner hangs from the lamppost, featuring a shield logo with a sunburst and the text "THINK CRITICALLY." and "St. Thomas" below it. In the background, a large, multi-story stone building with many windows is visible under a clear blue sky. Another lamppost with a purple banner is visible further back. The right side of the image is covered by a purple gradient overlay containing text.

Who works at Public Safety?

Our staff consists of:

- Director of Public Safety:
Zach DuBois
- St. Paul Campus and Clery
Compliance Manager:
Aaron Fimon
- Minneapolis Campus
Emergency Manager: Brian
Rich
- Community Liaison and
DEI Specialist: Reginald
Wright
- 2 Staff
Sergeants (Investigations
and Emergency
Management)
- 4 Patrol Sergeants
- 6 Dispatchers
- 19 Patrol Officers



Public Safety Emergency Call Boxes on campus

While you are walking through campus, you may have seen our Emergency Call Box stations.

- They have a bright blue light on the top, with a yellow box on the bottom.
- If you have an emergency and need to speak with Public Safety quickly, press the button.
- Our dispatch will answer the phone to begin gathering information. While this is happening, Public Safety Officers will get dispatched to your location to help.
- Additionally, we have emergency buttons in restrooms, locker rooms, and several other areas.

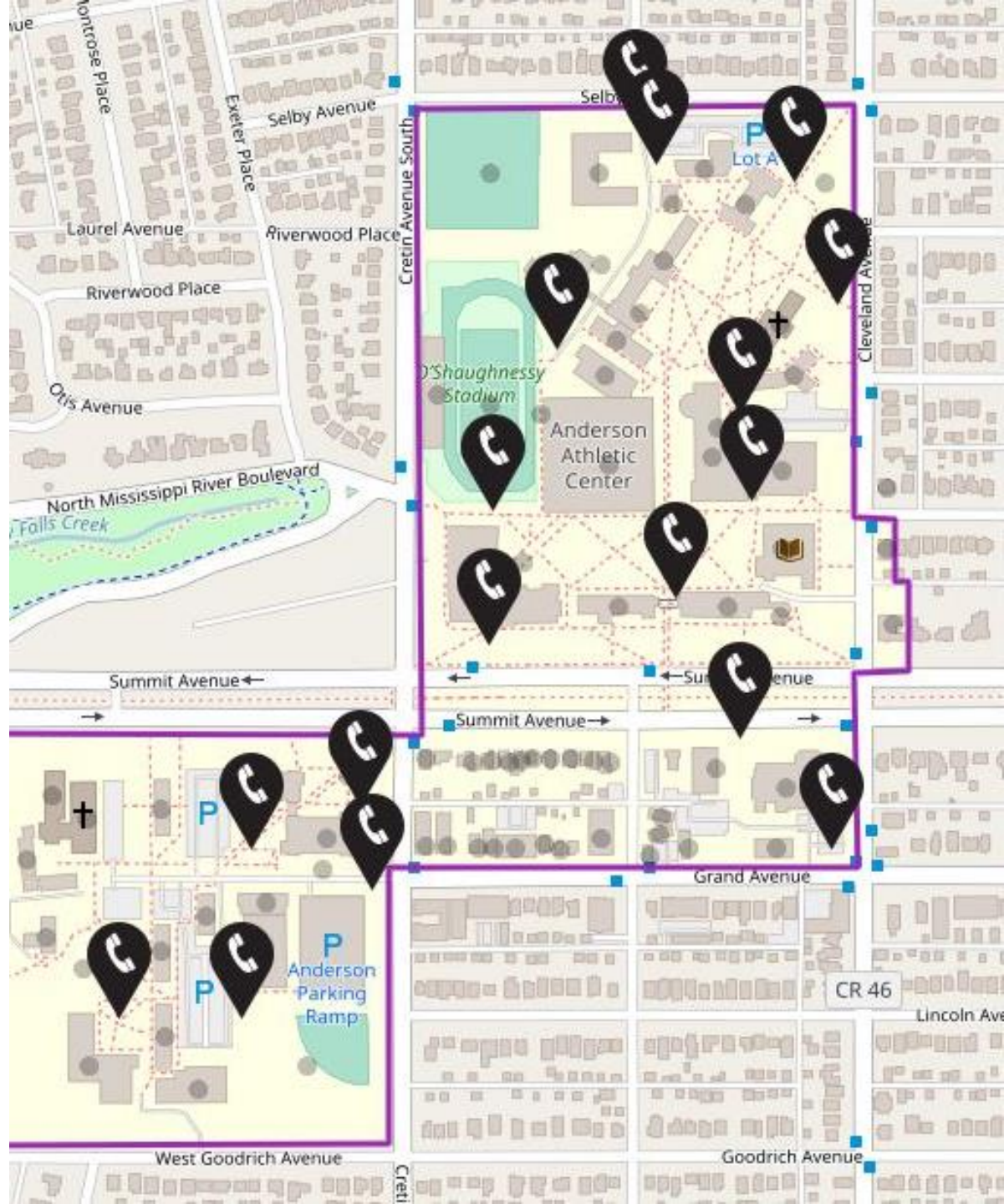


What do Call Boxes look like?



Where can I find a Call Box?

- Here are the locations of Emergency Call Boxes.
- Call Boxes are also located at the exterior of most residence halls.
- Please Note that due to construction some of these have been disabled or moved. That is why it is important to take a mental note when you see one.





Clery Act Compliance

According to Federal Law (Clery Act) you all are considered Campus Security Authorities (CSAs).

This means you are required to report any crimes that occur on campus to Public Safety. (You are not a confidential resource.)

You will be receiving the CSA training in your email from Public Safety Manager Aaron Fimon.

Please remember to take this training seriously. A violation of the Clery Act is \$72,000...for each violation!

Liberty University recently set a record for the highest fine in history...\$14 million.



Where Do I Report Crimes?

Great Question!

In a Residence Life report.

Residence Life professional staff.

To Public Safety.

When in doubt ask!

Typical Pub Safe and Res Life Calls

- Anything in a Residence Hall – for the most part.
- Liquor Law Violation - *Always a Report*
- Drug Law Violation - *Always a Report*
- Weapon Law Violation - *Always a Report*
- Noise Complaint
- Damage to Property
- Welfare Checks
- Any time Public Safety responds to a Residence Hall, you will likely be notified unless it is an access request, fire alarm, or mechanical malfunction





Our Response to a LLV or even a noise complaint

Generally, you will call our dispatch and notify us of a situation in a residence hall.

Our Dispatch will always send at least two Officers to the room.

- Upon arrival, officers will chat with you outside of the room to figure out what is going on.
- Depending on the situation we will knock or key into the room.
- Determine who lives in the room, collect ID's, figure out which alcohol in the room belongs to who, use a PBT to determine alcohol levels, conduct a Plainview search of the room, determine who can remain on their own or who needs to come back to our office, dump out alcohol, send people back to their rooms.
- Next, our Officers will be documenting the incident in a report. They will gather your name, ID number and title, then provide you with our names, badge numbers, and report number. Sometimes with a noise complaint, there is simply loud noise and no alcohol present. We will not always document a noise complaint.
- Our Officers will follow-up with the Hall Director Duty phone to let them know what happened.



Our Response to a Drug Law Violation or a Suspicious Odor

- Generally, you will call our dispatch and notify us of a situation in a residence hall, other times, our dispatcher will request an RA to respond.
- Our Dispatch will always send at least two Officers to the room.
- Upon arrival, officers chat with you outside of the room to figure out what is going on/or explain to you what is going on.
- Depending on situation we will knock or key into the room.
- Determine who lives in the room, collect IDs
- Officers will question the person about the smell and conduct a cursory search.
- Any items found; our Officers will determine who the item belongs to.
- Next, the evidence is gathered.
- Next, our Officers will be documenting the incident in a report. They will gather your name, ID number and title, then provide you with their names, badge numbers and our report number. Drug Law Violations and Suspicious Odors are always documented. If an Officer forgets to tell you the Report Number, please ask.
- Our Officers will follow-up with the Hall Director Duty phone to let them know what happened.

Some Pictures of Drugs – Found in Residence Halls





Additional Pictures of
Drugs found On-Campus



Our Response to a Welfare Check

- Usually, for Welfare Checks, we tend to hear about it first. Anytime our officers respond to a residence hall for a welfare check, we will be contacting Residence Life.
- Upon arrival, our officers will knock on the door and if no answer we will key in.
 - Sometimes upon entering, if no one is there, our Officers will conduct a plain-view search to see if there are any signs that the student was harmed or may have self-harmed. If no one is there, our Officers will provide you with our report number and clear from the call with you. Our officers will continue to track that student down until found. Our Officers will follow-up with a phone call to the HD to update them.
 - If a student is in the room, we will identify the problem and find a solution. It may be a situation where we feel comfortable letting that student remain in their room, or we get ahold of CAPS, or SPFD.
 - On Welfare checks, Pub Safe won't wait for you to get there to enter the room, but we will wait after to brief you about the situation.



Where to go for Information?

- For information you can always check out the St. Thomas Website.
- Under Murphy Online, you can add your cell phone number, so you receive UST Alerts for incidents on campus.



What to do in the event of a fire alarm?

01

If you hear a fire alarm in your building, please exit the building.

02

Even if you smell overcooked popcorn and you believe it is a false alarm, still tell your residents to evacuate.

03

If you **see** a fire, please contact Public Safety at 651-962-5555.



What to do in the event of Severe Weather?

If our campus is in the warning area of severe weather, seek shelter immediately. (For shelter locations, see Campus Emergency Guide)

When a Severe Weather Watch/Warning is issued for our area, Public Safety follows a Weather Emergency Protocol. The following departments are contacted and advised of the storm:

On-Call Hall Director for Residence Life

Circulation desk for the LIB

ASC Duty Phone

Facilities Management

In situations where the storm has been known to produce significant damage, our Public Safety Director may make a notification of our systems



Bomb Threat

- Depending upon the circumstances, the Police Bomb Squad may be dispatched to the scene.
- Depending upon the circumstances, a search of the building may be conducted under the direction of Public Safety and the Police.
- The Police Bomb Squad will contact and interview the person who received the bomb threat.
- An evacuation may take place.
- When authorized, the “All Clear” will be given by the Public Safety Department.



Active Shooter Threat

- Run, Hide, Fight
 - If possible, please give Public Safety a call @ 651-962-5555
 - Provide a description of the person, nature of behavior, and last known location of the person.
 - We will contact the Police

Run: If an active shooter is in your vicinity

Hide: If you cannot evacuate or get out safely, you need to find a place to hide, remain quiet and calm.

Fight: As a last resort, and only if your life is in danger

When Law Enforcement arrives: Remain calm and follow instructions



Active Shooter Continued:

- We train Run. Hide. Fight. Because it is endorsed Nationally and by the FBI.
- Another acronym we like to use is: ADD
- Avoid = Run
- Deny = hide
- Defend = Fight
- Research has shown in active shooter emergencies, the majority of those injured or killed are hiding. They forgot to barricade themselves, or hide in a way to effectively transition to the fight if necessary.
- The next part of Run. Hide. Fight is the preparation and planning through a personal safety plan.



Personal Safety Plan – Answered:

A Safety Plan makes you think about your environment: campus, classroom, bar, movie theater, shopping mall etc.

- Be aware of all your surroundings and environment
- Think about these questions:
 - Where am I
 - Where are the exits
 - What are my risks at this location
 - What would I do if there was a....
 - What are the tools around me
 - Where do I Run
 - How do I hide
 - How do I fight



Personal Safety Plan – Answered continued:

- A personal safety plan is an opportunity to do scenario-based response planning.
 - It creates muscle memory
 - You will never imagine how something will look, but you can draw on your experiences as tools to help you survive.
- **Summary of Run. Hide. Fight?**
- Personal Safety plan
- Plan ahead
- Scenario based exercises
- Breaking down Run. Hide. Fight.
 - This is not a checklist, all three are options.
- Run: Run far, run long, don't wait. Hands up for Law Enforcement
- Hide: Lock/Barricade, property is not an issue, break a window, lights out, phone on silent
- Fight: All-IN, get to their level, No hesitation



Community Liaison and DEI Specialist Role



- Community Engagement Initiatives
- Building trust with groups on campus through:
 - Engagement events
- Providing education and training to other student, staff and faculty groups on campus. Ex: CPR/ First Aid classes.



Body Worn Cameras

- We are dedicated to holding our officers to the highest standard.
- These cameras allow us to review footage if we need more information for a report, received a complaint about how a call was handled, or used to debrief officers so that we can improve our response.
- These cameras are always buffering. As soon as they are activated, they save all video footage up to 2 minutes prior to the activation.
- Officers activate these cameras on every call even escorts and access requests.
- If the red blinking light is on it is recording. If the light is solid green, it is buffering (pre-recording).
- We have seen a significant decrease in complaints since we issued these cameras to officers.
- It also has also helped build trust with those who may have had poor experiences with law enforcement in the past.



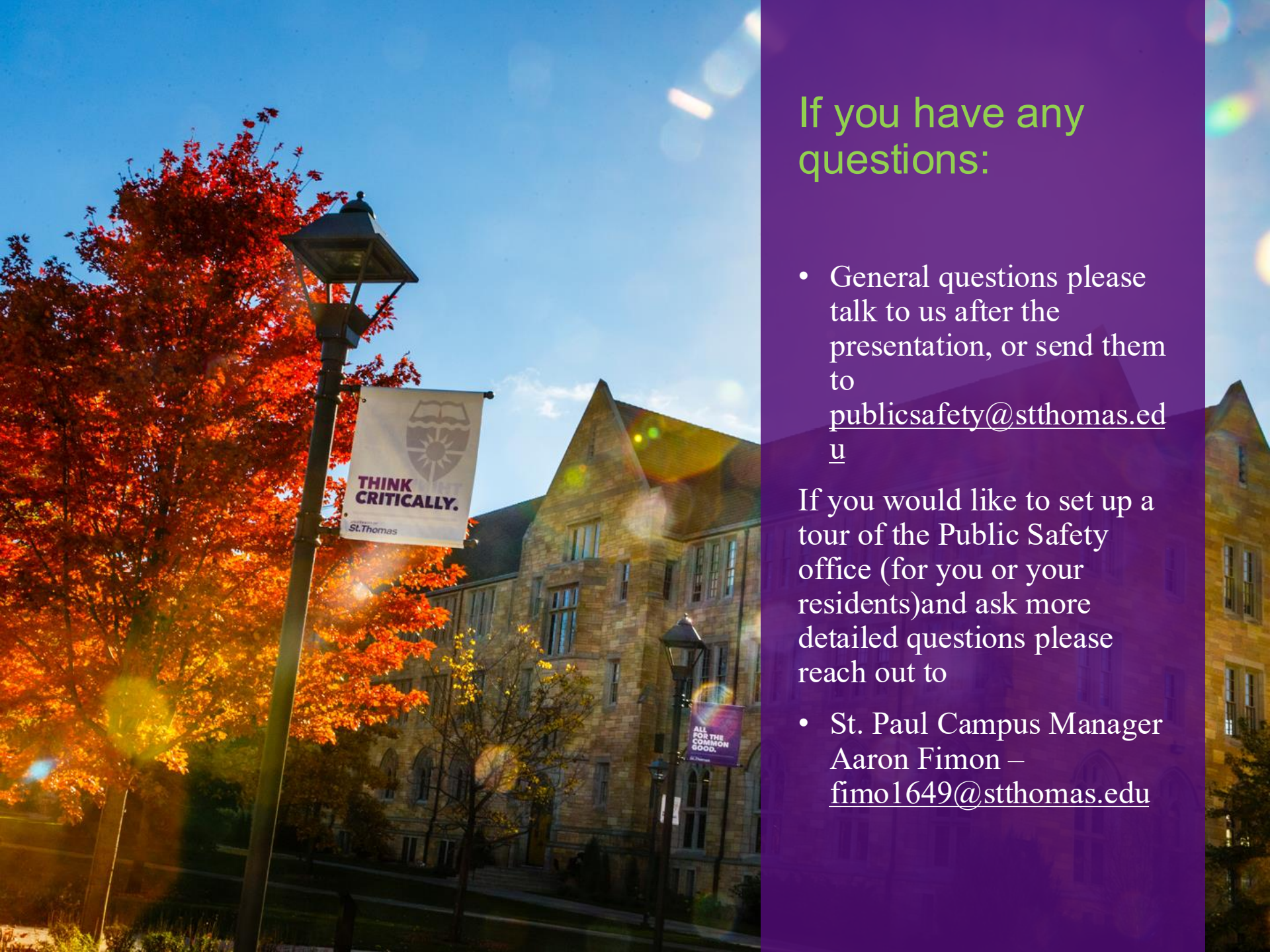
Summary of what we talked about today

- Where are we located
- How to call us
- How to message us
- How to get information
- Public Safety Staff
- Emergency Call Boxes on Campus
- CSA
- How to report
- Typical call response
- What to do for different types of situations





Questions?

The background of the slide is a photograph of a university campus. On the left, there are trees with vibrant autumn foliage in shades of red, orange, and yellow. In the center and right, a large, multi-story stone building with many windows is visible. A black lamppost stands in the foreground on the left, with a white banner hanging from it that reads "THINK CRITICALLY." and "St. Thomas" below it. Another smaller banner is visible on a lamppost further back, reading "ALL FOR THE COMMON GOOD." The sky is a clear, bright blue.

If you have any questions:

- General questions please talk to us after the presentation, or send them to publicsafety@stthomas.edu

If you would like to set up a tour of the Public Safety office (for you or your residents) and ask more detailed questions please reach out to

- St. Paul Campus Manager
Aaron Fimon –
fimo1649@stthomas.edu